SHORT · APACHE SPARK

What is Apache Spark?

Apache Spark is an engine for processing data. It splits a big job into small tasks and runs them in parallel across many machines.

Key points

- Think of counting a huge stack of receipts. Ten people each count one pile, then add their totals together.
- In Databricks Free Edition, Spark is ready for you. Click New, then Notebook, and run a cell with Shift + Enter.
- You write Python or SQL. Spark plans the work and runs it.
- Every DataFrame you use in Databricks is processed by Spark.

Tiny example

Create a range of one million numbers with spark.range, then call count. Spark splits the numbers into partitions and counts them in parallel. The expected result is a comment, not a recorded printout.

```
numbers = spark.range(1000000)
numbers.count()

# Expected result: 1000000
```

Misconception check

> You do not install or start Spark yourself in Databricks, and Spark is not a separate language you must learn first. You write Python or SQL. Spark plans the work and runs it.

Remember

Spark splits big data work into pieces and runs them in parallel.

The Short says Spark is ready for you in Databricks Free Edition.